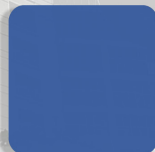


# REHABILITATION and RECOVERY PLAN

for the NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION

(RRP-NCR)

ABRIDGED VERSION







# REGIONAL TASK FORCE COVID-19 NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION

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Rehabilitation and Recovery Plan  
for the National Capital Region  
(RRP-NCR)

Abridged Version



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### **Rehabilitation and Recovery Plan for the National Capital Region Abridged Version**

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The coronavirus disease (COVID-19) is an infectious disease caused by the novel coronavirus strain officially named Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome Coronavirus 2 (SARS-CoV-2). First reported in Wuhan City, Hubei Province, China in late December 2019, COVID-19 spread internationally within months and has since become a major global public health crisis.

The Philippines recorded its first confirmed case of COVID-19 on January 30, 2020. The subsequent rise in the number of COVID-19 cases prompted President Rodrigo Roa Duterte to impose community quarantine restrictions with the primary objective of minimizing the risk and slowing down the rate of transmission. Community quarantine took effect in the National Capital Region (NCR) on March 15, 2020. On March 17, 2020, NCR was placed under a stricter Enhanced Community Quarantine (ECQ) together with the rest of Luzon.

The current public health emergency adversely affects the overall living conditions in NCR. To address the social and economic fallout from the COVID-19 crisis and to facilitate the region's transition to the "new normal," the Metropolitan Manila Development Authority (MMDA) crafted the Rehabilitation and Recovery Plan for the National Capital Region (RRP-NCR), in close coordination with regional line agencies (RLAs) and local government units (LGUs), and with assistance from the private sector and community-based organizations.

The RRP-NCR was formulated with the following objectives: (1) to characterize the responses to the COVID-19 crisis and (2) to consolidate the rehabilitation and recovery efforts of various stakeholders and partners toward transitioning to the new normal. The Plan was developed in accordance with the *We Recover As One* report published by the Inter-agency Task Force Technical Working Group for Anticipatory and Forward Planning (IATF-TWG-AFP), with the National Economic and Development Authority (NEDA) as lead agency.

The RRP-NCR discusses the effects of the COVID-19 crisis in the region, the response interventions undertaken to mitigate the identified impacts, and the rehabilitation and recovery strategies to adapt to the new normal. It contains the list of programs and projects needed to carry out the strategies set out in the plan.

## Framework and Major Thematic Areas

Identified strategies in the RRP-NCR are anchored on the sets of “new normal” indicated in the *We Recover as One* report of the IATF-TWG-AFP. To ensure success, the RRP-NCR relies on joint planning and action by RLAs and LGUs, and assisted by the private sector, communities, and community-based organizations.

### Long-Term Goal

The long-term goal of the Regional Rehabilitation and Recovery Framework is anchored on the long-term development vision of the country stated in the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Framework, which is to have “***safer, adaptive, and disaster-resilient Filipino communities that are protected from risk and can cope with and recover quickly from emerging and infectious disease outbreaks.***”

### Medium-Term Goal

The Framework’s medium-term goal is to “***restore the socioeconomic conditions in NCR while building higher resilience to health emergencies and reducing poverty.***”

### Sector Outcomes

#### Economic

Access to and opportunities for sustainable economic activities and income restored

#### Health and Nutrition

A responsive health care delivery system fully equipped to ensure continuous access to quality health services and affordable, safe, and nutritious food during emergencies and disasters

#### Social

Access to social protection, employment, housing, and education programs improved

#### Peace and Security

Orderly, safe, and peaceful environment ensured during emergencies

## Environment

Safe, clean, and healthy environment for urban communities ensured to prevent future disease outbreaks

## Infrastructure and Transportation

Continued, reliable, and seamless delivery of services ensured through safe and responsive infrastructure during disease outbreaks or similar events

## Governance

Capacity of Metro Manila LGUs and regional line agencies to effectively plan, collaborate, and partner with stakeholders to address public health emergencies ensured

## Immediate Objective

The Framework's immediate objective, adopted from the *We Recover As One* report, is to ***convey the right information to the public to gain trust and confidence.***

## General Strategies

Strategies designed to facilitate the attainment of desired outcomes were classified based on three main objectives of the IATF-TWG-AFP, namely: to convey the right information to the public to gain public trust and confidence; to mitigate losses; and to adapt to the new normal.

Identified strategies are clustered into the following: (1) response strategies to mitigate losses to ensure food security and reduce financial losses sustained and (2) rehabilitation and recovery strategies that aim to address the new set of challenges arising from the COVID-19 crisis and facilitate the transition to the new normal. These strategies were supported by identified priority programs and projects to be implemented by RLAs and Metro Manila LGUs.

## Cross-cutting Concerns

The Framework recognizes the significance of responding to cross-cutting development concerns, which encompass the infrastructure and transportation, environment, and governance sectors and which will require interlaced strategies with other sectors. These concerns relate to strengthening resilience, gender-responsiveness, poverty reduction, and cultural sensitivity.



## Institutional Structure and Planning Process

The MMDA, as chair of the Metro Manila Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council (MMDRRMC) and the Regional Task Force COVID-19 National Capital Region (RTF NCR), is tasked to formulate the RRP-NCR. In crafting the Plan, the MMDA, together with RLAs, LGUs, and other stakeholders, adopted a formulation process guided by the National Disaster Risk Reduction Management Council (NDRRMC) Rehabilitation and Recovery Planning Guide and the *We Recover As One* document prepared by the IATF-TWG-AFP.

The drafting of the RRP-NCR started with a desktop assessment of the NCR situation before the COVID-19 pandemic and its subsequent effects on the region. The Plan also included responses to mitigate losses, as well as investment programs of RLAs, LGUs, the private sector, and non-governmental organizations in NCR. The Secretariat prepared a preliminary draft and presented it to the concerned stakeholders through virtual meetings/consultations for inputs and suggestions.

To facilitate coordination in the formulation of the RRP-NCR, Metro Manila stakeholders were classified into seven (7) sectors based on their mandates. These are: 1) Health and Nutrition, 2) Social, 3) Peace and Security, 4) Economic, 5) Infrastructure and Transportation, 6) Environment, and 7) Governance.

The identified sectors refined the strategies contained in this Plan, in adherence to their respective goals and objectives and shaped by the identified effects of the pandemic and characterization of the new normal. These strategies were translated to corresponding programs, projects, and activities by the respective agencies, which will be included in the investment programming covering fiscal years 2020 to 2022.

To finalize the RRP-NCR, a validation workshop was conducted to confirm the inputs and suggestions of the stakeholders. The draft RRP-NCR was then provided to the stakeholders for final vetting. A Certificate of Concurrence was requested from the concerned stakeholders to signify their approval of the Plan.

## EFFECTS OF COVID-19 IN THE NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION

### Implementation of the Enhanced Community Quarantine in Luzon

On March 12, 2020 President Duterte ordered the imposition of strict community quarantine in NCR from March 15 to April 12, 2020 to prevent further COVID-19 transmission. Mass gathering was prohibited and all classes and government work in NCR were suspended while retaining skeleton workforces in government agencies to maintain delivery of public services.

Amid the rising confirmed COVID-19 cases, President Duterte declared a state of calamity over the entire country on March 16, 2020, through Proclamation No. 929, s. 2020. Subsequently, the Office of the President declared ECQ over NCR and the rest of Luzon from March 17 to April 13, by virtue of a Memorandum from the Executive Secretary, in accordance with Proclamation No. 929, Proclamation 922, s. 2020, and RA 11332.

Salient protocols of the ECQ and the attendant stringent social distancing measures implemented include:

1. Suspension of all classes and school activities;
2. Prohibition of mass gatherings;
3. Observance of strict home quarantine except for accessing basic necessities;
4. Implementation of work-from-home arrangement in the Executive Branch of the government except for uniformed and health and emergency frontline personnel;
5. Operation of industries limited to businesses that provide basic necessities and activities related to food and medicine production;
6. Suspension of mass public transportation; and
7. Restriction of land, air, and sea travel

Through Executive Order (EO) No. 112, President Duterte approved the IATF recommendations to implement a community quarantine classification system based

on risk parameters in containing the spread of COVID-19 and extend the ECQ in NCR for another 15 days ending on May 15, 2020.

On May 15, 2020, the President approved the recommendations of the IATF through Resolution No. 37, which placed NCR under Modified ECQ (the transition phase between ECQ and GCQ) starting May 16 until the end of the month. During the MECQ, more businesses were allowed to operate with 50 percent of their employees on-site, although public transportation was still restricted. Modified GCQ was added to the community quarantine classifications on May 22, 2020 to refer to the transition phase between GCQ and the “new normal.” On May 29, 2020, the President, through Resolution No. 41, approved the recommendation of the IATF to place all highly-urbanized cities (HUCs) in NCR and the Municipality of Pateros under GCQ until June 15, 2020, being classified as high-risk.

Starting June 16 until August 15, 2020, the GCQ status of Metro Manila was extended for 15-day periods multiple times thereafter by virtue of IATF Resolutions Nos. 46A, 50A, 55A, and 60A. On August 3, 2020, following the request for a two-week ECQ by the country’s medical associations and other allied health organizations, the Office of the President placed NCR, Laguna, Cavite, Rizal, and Bulacan under Modified Enhanced Community Quarantine until August 18, 2020. Thereafter, NCR’s community quarantine classification status was reverted to GCQ.

On August 31, 2020, the IATF recommended a community quarantine classification of GCQ for all LGUs in Metro Manila until 31 September 2020, per IATF Resolution No. 67.

## Assessment of Damages and Losses

NCR, as the center of economic, government, and social activities in the Philippines, enjoys a vibrant regional economy. Being the hotspot of COVID-19 in the country, however, the region has sustained the most significant economic impact from the imposition of temporary closures of business establishments, limited consumer spending, restricted travels, and other economic disruptions.

### Regional Economic Impact

NCR, which is mostly dependent on the services and industry sectors, is the largest contributor to the Gross Domestic Product (GDP) among regions, contributing 36 percent in 2018. Operational disruptions brought about by the COVID-19 pandemic entailed great losses to the region’s economy.

The Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas stated that the shutdown of Luzon will slow down the Philippine economy, with the disruptive impact lasting until the second half of 2020. The economy is expected to rebound in 2021. Moreover, based on the *We Recover As One* report, the 45-day lockdown period in Luzon had caused an estimated initial impact amounting to PhP 589.25 billion in NCR or 7.89 percent of its 2020 Gross Regional Domestic Product.

The services sector registered the largest estimated losses with PhP 454.84 billion, especially on retail trade (PhP30.95 billion) and tourism (PhP 706.32 million). Meanwhile, The industry sector recorded an estimated PhP 134.41 billion in losses, specifically with manufacturing (PhP 108.02), construction (PhP 24.37 billion), and mining and quarrying (PhP 2.01 billion).

The slowdown of the production of goods and services and the hampered flow of inputs are seen to decrease productivity of labor and output in the region. NCR's slower rate of economic growth may be aggravated by the pandemic. The impacts COVID-19 on NCR are summarized below:

- ***Inflation.*** NCR's inflation rate declined to 1.4 percent in May 2020 from 2.0 percent in February 2020, significantly lower compared to 3.4 percent in the same month of the previous year
- ***Poverty.*** The COVID-19 pandemic's drastic implications on the operations of enterprises and employment may increase NCR's poverty and subsistence incidence at a relatively higher rate.
- ***Employment.*** According to PSA, unemployment rate in NCR in April 2020 has reached 12.3 percent, which translates to 664,920 unemployed persons. This represents an increase from the January 2020 unemployment rate of 6.2 percent or 364,920 unemployed persons. The COVID-19 pandemic and the economic closure of the Philippine labor market were seen as contributory factors to the increased unemployment rate.

## Sectoral Assessment

### Economic

In the services sector, enterprises related to retail trade, tourism, private education, and remittances were the most affected by the pandemic and community quarantine.

Domestic trade could be negatively affected due to low demand for non-essential commodities/goods. It is important to underscore that trade is one

of the main drivers of NCR's economy. Meanwhile, The travel and tourism sector is among the most affected, with NEDA estimating a PhP 93-187 billion reduction in gross value added, mainly in the trade and tourism sectors, which is equivalent to 0.4-0.9 percent of the GDP. In NCR, the estimated foregone revenue for the tourism sector amounted to PhP 5.44 billion.

## **Transportation**

The imposition of community quarantine entailed the restriction of land, air, and sea travel. This involved the suspension of mass transportation, including trains, buses, jeepneys, taxis, and tricycles in addition to domestic and international flights. This resulted in the interrupted delivery of commodities and other resources through freight and importation and exportation deliveries, as well as limited ridership capacity of public transportation due to additional safety guidelines.

The ECQ in Luzon severely affected about 500,000 jeepney drivers and 200,000 small-time operators. Moreover, the restrictions set for the community quarantine increased the reliance on various information and communication technologies, including the shift of private and government processes to online transactions. This is one of the factors impacting the shift in energy consumption demand among commercial, industrial, and residential users that may trigger an energy price spike (e.g., LPG, electricity, gasoline, and diesel).

## **Governance**

The fiscal capacity of LGUs relies on revenue generation, specifically on tax collected in the use of properties or the fiscal space. Given that most business establishments shall remain close or non-operational at varying degrees during the community quarantine, revenue generation of LGUs is affected as well.

## **Social Aspect**

The COVID-19 crisis resulted in limited access to basic necessities due to the abrupt closure of certain establishments, limited operating hours, and imposition of curfew. In the education sector, the pandemic led to the closure or stoppage of private and public schools in order to suspend face-to-face contact with the vulnerable population. Based on the consolidated report of the Department of Education-NCR as of September 1, 2020, a total of 97 private schools have closed or not opened for SY 2020-2021 and 869 teachers were displaced in the region. Total enrollment for SY 2020-2021 as of September 4, 2020 is 2,530,905, which is equivalent to 85.55-percent turnout compared to SY 2019-2020.

## **Health**

NCR has the highest number of confirmed COVID-19 cases among regions and ranks first in terms of the number of newly-announced fresh cases as of August 2020.

Based on the monitoring report prepared by the Department of Health-Metro Manila Center for Health Development as of August 27, 2020, NCR recorded a total of 67,231 confirmed cases, 1,715 of which were new cases. Of the total confirmed cases, 13,163 active cases, 50,288 recoveries, and 2,372 deaths were recorded. Among LGUs, Quezon City registered the highest number of cases (10,736), followed by the City of Manila with 7,632.

The rising COVID-19 cases in the region creates a directly proportional demand and puts stress on the regional health capacity in terms of health facilities and manpower

## **Environment**

Air pollution levels in NCR decreased by 40 percent to 66 percent during the first weeks of the ECQ. However, as community quarantine restrictions are eased up, air pollution levels are evidently rebounding.

Meanwhile, the volume of solid waste generated, particularly medical and other hazardous wastes from health care facilities and households, is expected to increase

## **Peace and Security**

During the ECQ, a number of crimes monitored were directly related to violations of quarantine or COVID-19 control regulations, such as curfews or liquor bans. This is on top of crimes monitored even without COVID-19, such as domestic violence and arrested persons.

However, it was noted that for the period from March 15 to July 10, 2020, the incidence of eight (8) focus major crimes (murder, homicide, physical injury, rape, robbery, theft, carnapping (MC/MV) decreased by 60.06 percent to 1,590, from 3,981 incidents in 2019 during the same period.

## Response from the National Government and Regional Line Agencies

The sustained impacts brought about by the COVID-19 pandemic required national government agencies, along with RLAs, to provide relief assistance to the affected population through cash assistance, loan assistance, in-kind assistance, and other relevant responses.

### Emergency Cash Assistance

RA 11649 or the *Bayanihan To Heal As One Act* stipulates the provision of emergency subsidy, through the Emergency Subsidy Program (ESP), to around 18 million low-income households. Subsidy for NCR beneficiaries was set at PhP 8,000.00, based on the minimum daily wage rate of PhP 537.00. The implementation of ESP was undertaken through existing subsidy programs of the National Government and augmented by the pooled savings from discontinued unreleased appropriations, consistent with Section 4(v) of the *Bayanihan To Heal As One Act*.

The following are the emergency response programs currently being implemented by several government agencies such as DSWD, DTI, and DOLE:

- ***Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps)***. The Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program, in relation to the COVID-19 pandemic, is implemented in two (2) tranches.
- ***Assistance to Individuals in Crisis Situations (AICS) Program***. The AICS Program is intended for low-income families who are non-4Ps beneficiaries.
- ***Social Pension (SocPen) for Indigent Senior Citizens and Persons with Disabilities (PWDs)***. SocPen is provided to eligible indigent senior citizens to augment their capacity to meet their daily subsistence and medical requirements amid the COVID-19 pandemic.
- ***Livelihood Assistance Grant (LAG)***. LAG is a financial assistance program for Sustainable Livelihood Program (SLP) beneficiaries with at least one (1) member who is an affected worker in the informal sector.

- ***Assistance to Transport Network Vehicle Service (TNVS) and Public Utility Vehicle (PUV) Drivers.*** Drivers of Public Utility Jeepneys (PUJs), UV Express, Public Utility Buses (PUBs), Point-to-Point Buses (P2Ps), taxis, TNVS, school transports, and motorcycle (MC) taxis are eligible to receive financial assistance amounting to PhP 8,000 each.
- ***COVID-19 Adjustment Measures Program (CAMP).*** CAMP provides PhP 5,000.00 financial assistance to affected workers in the private sector.
- ***Tulong Panghanapbuhay sa Ating Disadvantaged/Displaced Workers Barangay Ko, Bahay Ko Disinfection/Sanitation Project (TUPAD #BKBK).*** TUPAD #BKBK provides temporary wage employment to the displaced, underemployed, and self-employed workers by requiring them to disinfect and sanitize their own residence and its contiguous vicinity.
- ***Abot Kamay ang Pagtulong (AKAP) for Displaced Overseas Filipino Workers (OFWs).*** AKAP provides a one-time financial assistance of USD 200 or PhP 10,000.00 or the host country's local currency equivalent to OFWs who were displaced due to the COVID-19 crisis.

## Emergency Loan Assistance/Loan Moratoriums

Government agencies and government-owned and controlled corporations (GOCCs) made available the following loan facilities in support of efforts to cushion the impacts of COVID-19 pandemic: (1) COVID-19 Pondo Para sa Pagbabago at Pag-Asenso Enterprise Rehabilitation Fund (P3-ERF)/COVID-19 Assistance to Restart Enterprises (CARES) Program; (2) GSIS Emergency Loan Facility; and (3) Philippine Guarantee Corporation or PHILGUARANTEE Credit Guarantee Facility.

## Emergency Assistance/Subsidy to MSMEs

- ***Livelihood Seeding Program/Negosyo Serbisyo sa Barangay (LSP-NSB).*** LSP-NSB assists MSMEs affected by natural and human-induced calamities, including health disasters, through the provision of livelihood kits and business advisory assistance and services amounting to at least PhP 5,000 up to PhP 8,000.
- ***Pangkabuhayan sa Pagbangon at Ginawa (PBG) Program.*** DTI-NCR's PBG program provides financial assistance and entrepreneurial training to around 2,600 micro or would-be entrepreneurs affected by calamities.
- ***Small Business Wage Subsidy Program.*** This Program, implemented by the Department of Finance through the Social Security System, provides wage subsidy amounting from PhP 5,000.00 to PhP 8,000.00 to affected workers engaged in small businesses.



## In-kind Assistance

- ***Transportation Assistance.*** Several government agencies have been providing transportation assistance to health workers, frontliners, and OFWs, as well as logistical assistance for the distribution of medical supplies and food relief since the imposition of the community quarantine.
- ***Food and Non-Food Items Distribution.*** Food and non-food items were provided by government agencies to various targeted beneficiaries amid the COVID-19 pandemic.
- ***Assistance to Repatriated Overseas Filipino and Locally Stranded Individuals.*** Several government agencies assisted ROFs, LSIs, and OFWs to facilitate their return to their homes without compromising the health of the people around them.

## Responsive Infrastructure and Transportation Policies

Other government agencies that do not have a direct connection with distressed sectors have focused their efforts instead on helping the economy with various policies to cope with the pandemic.

- DPWH released guidelines, (e.g., DPWH Department Order Nos. 35 and 39), to facilitate the continuation of infrastructure projects amid ongoing health crisis and to fast-track infrastructure projects for COVID-19 response, including quarantine facilities and offsite dormitories for medical frontliners.
- MMDA suspended the Unified Vehicular Volume Reduction Program or Number Coding Scheme to support more people travelling while in quarantine.
- DOTr implemented the Omnibus Public Transport Protocols to allow the resumption of public transport with proper social distancing guidelines and load reduction factors.
- In pandemic and post-pandemic scenarios, the Pasig River Ferry Service (PRFS) has been developed to provide a safe, reliable and efficient alternative nautical transport system that will help decongest road traffic and serve as a disaster response for a more sustainable Metro Manila.
- DOE ensured that the supply of fuels and power remained stable. DOE, through the Energy Regulatory Commission (ERC) likewise recommended the deferment of payment for electricity bills at the consumers' end, as well as the deferment of related bills along the power supply chain.

## Support on Health and Nutrition

DOH-NCR has continuously conveyed information on community quarantine classification and social distancing guidelines and protocols to the public, and monitored COVID-19 cases figures in the region. The agency also ensured sufficient manpower and streamlined operations in all its district/regional swabbing centers by providing emergency hiring and pre-deployment human resource orientation to its newly hired nurses.

NNC-NCR has continued to support and advocate nutrition policies through coordination and dissemination of the 2020 Regional Nutrition Committee Resolutions and Nutrition Cluster Advisories to LGUs and partner agencies; continuous promotion of proper Infant and Young Child Feeding (IYCF) practices amid the pandemic; implementation of capacity-building activities and nutrition promotion campaigns through social media platforms; and regular monitoring of LGU compliance to nutrition cluster advisories and related issuances.

## Guidelines on the Management of the Dead

Guidelines on the management of COVID-19-related deaths were issued on March 27, 2020 through DILG Memorandum Circular (MC) No. 2020-063 series of 2020, otherwise known as the *Interim Guidelines on the Management of the Dead*.

In connection with this, DILG-NCR, as the lead agency for the Management of the Dead and Missing Person of MMDRRMC, developed the Management of the Dead Monitoring System (MDMS) and provided guidelines on how to access and utilize the said system. Through the DILG-NCR Field Offices, a series of orientation on the proper handling and disposal of COVID-19 cadavers were conducted with NCR-LGUs.

## COVID-19 Online Data Platforms

Various online platforms and applications were developed and launched by government agencies and key partners to provide different stakeholder groups relevant and updated information amid the COVID-19 crisis. These include (1) Laging Handa Unified Website; (2) Feasibility Analysis of Syndromic Surveillance using Spatio-Temporal Epidemiological Modeler (FASSSTER); (3) COVID KAYA; (4) DOH DataCollect; and (5) Katuwang na Impormasyon para sa Responsableng Akasyon (KIRA) KontraCOVID.

## Response from Local Government Units

In response to the effects of COVID-19, Metro Manila LGUs immediately attended to the needs of their constituents through the following interventions:

### Managing COVID-19 Cases and Public Health

In support to the increasing need for quarantine and testing facilities, several LGUs established and operated quarantine and testing facilities to accommodate COVID-19 patients. Rapid and swab testing were conducted, with priority given to medical frontliners and suspected and probable COVID-19 cases.

Other measures to control the spread of the disease include the implementation of social distancing, temperature and health screening in public facilities and places and in business and commercial establishments, and distribution of health-related IEC materials to these establishments.

### Workers' Welfare

- ***Assistance to Frontliners.*** LGUs provided assistance and support to frontliners through the provision of transportation, food, PPEs, accommodation facilities, cash allowance, and hazard pay.
- ***Assistance to OFWs and Locally Stranded Individuals.*** OFWs and locally stranded individuals (LSIs) were provided with support, such as accommodation, food or meals, and transportation.
- ***Assistance to Temporarily Closed Businesses/Industries and MSMEs.*** Affected businesses, industries, and MSMEs that were forced to temporarily close down during the community quarantine were given emergency loan assistance. Workers in the informal sector were provided cash assistance.
- ***Assistance to the Informal Sector.*** Cash and livelihood assistance, as well as food packs, were provided to PUV drivers, such as taxi/cab, jeepney, tricycle, pedicab drivers.
- ***Assistance to the Public.*** Pop-up bike lanes, as well as bike racks were provided by every LGUs within their jurisdiction to ensure the safety of bikers. Isolation/quarantine centers, 24/7 contact tracing facilities, and molecular diagnostic laboratories for COVID-19 were also provided, while others LGUs developed a COVID-19 Contact Tracing App for their constituents.

## Provision of Relief Assistance

LGUs provided financial assistance and relief packs to households and individuals affected by the ECQ through the implementation of emergency relief programs. Moreover, LGUs coordinated with private entities, the academe, non-governmental organizations, and development partners in collecting and distributing donations to their constituents.

## Provision of Basic Needs

To encourage compliance to health protocols and measures among their constituents, LGUs provided easier access to basic necessities, including the provision of mobile drugstores, mobile stores, and mobile automated teller machines (ATMs), among others.

## Travel Restrictions

In order to control the spread of COVID-19, it is necessary to minimize contact among people and encourage staying at home. Given this, LGUs have imposed mobility restrictions that limit the movement of people except for essential activities at assigned schedules and areas, including purchasing food and other basic necessities.

## Vulnerable Groups' Welfare

LGUs provided free transportation, online consultations, and cash assistance to vulnerable groups and immediately attended to their medical needs. Temporary shelter, food, medical and hygiene needs and relief assistance were also provided to street dwellers and informal settler families.

## Response from the Private Sector and Non-Governmental Organizations

The private sector and NGOs also played a critical role at the local, international, and global levels during this time of COVID-19 pandemic. The following are some of the reported initiatives in NCR and in the country.

### Financial Assistance

Through donations and fundraising initiatives, among others, private sector organizations helped address the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic by supporting national and local frontline health providers currently serving in various hospitals and in their identified local communities to combat the disease. These private sector organizations include Gokongwei Brothers Foundation, JG Summit Holdings, Inc. Megaworld Corporation, Aboitiz Group, Alliance Global Group Inc & Subsidiaries, and ABS-CBN.

### Services Assistance

- JG Summit/The Robinsons Retail Holdings, Inc., Megaworld Corporation, and SM Prime Holdings, Inc. continued the operation of their establishments that provide basic necessities to the public, including supermarkets, malls, banks, pharmacies, hardware, and restaurants.
- Cebu Pacific, under JG Summit Holdings, Inc., also provided assistance to passengers who have flights until April 30 by offering them the option to rebook their flights anytime until June 30 or place the cost of the ticket in a travel fund to be used for future travel.
- Maynilad Water Services, Inc. installed contactless handwash stations in their concession area and conducted Free desludging for quarantine facilities.
- Meralco implemented dispersed operation of their Back-up Control Centers and deployed Networks Emergency Operations Personnel and skeleton workforce to reduce the chances of power outages in Metro Manila, especially for vital government agencies and medical institutions.
- The Cebu-based family foundation Ramon Aboitiz Foundation, Inc. aided stranded passengers at seaports and provided livelihood to small and micro-entrepreneurs whose income was affected by the pandemic.

## Moratorium Assistance

Several private companies have implemented moratoriums and extended the payment deadlines of some of their services, including Manila Water Company, Inc. (water services), Meralco (electricity services), Robinsons Land Corp. (rental charges), Robinsons Bank (loan products), Aboitiz Group (electricity services).

## In-kind Assistance: Food and Non-food Distribution

The private sector and NGOs also distributed food and non-food items, including bottled water, hygiene kits, food packs, disinfectant alcohol, PPEs, medical supplies, sanitation kits, mobile storage units, and COVID-19 testing labs, among others. These organizations include Manila Water Company, Inc., Manila Water Foundation, Ayala Corporation, Makati Development Corporation, JG Summit Holdings, Inc., Megaworld Corporation, Meralco and One Meralco Foundation, World Vision Development Foundation-Philippines, Maynilad Water Services, Inc., ABS-CBN Lingkod Kapamilya, and ABS-CBN Bantay Kalikasan, among others.

## Other Efforts

World Vision Development Foundation-Philippines conducted orientations and distributed awareness materials to 1.4 million people through mass media and face-to-face orientation.

ABS-CBN Bantay Kalikasan through the conduct of the *Kaalaman at Komunidad para sa KALIKASAN*, which aims to empower and connect grassroots communities in the new normal, and *buyANI-han para sa KALIKASAN*, which aims to help community-based social enterprises manage and develop their products; to connect producers to market so that they can benefit from the value chain; to provide feedback on market needs and wants and journey with them to grow and foster Community Supported Agriculture ecosystems.

During the quarantine period, the La Mesa Watershed and Ecopark continued to implement 24/7 watershed protection and reported zero incidence of forest fires despite closure of its operations to the public.

There is a need to define or characterize the “new normal” as the country moves forward post-COVID-19 pandemic based on the *We Recover As One* report. This section discusses how various sectors can overcome the restrictions brought about by the pandemic and how they can resume or adapt their respective social and economic activities.

## Economy

### Regional Economy

NCR’s economy is expected to be greatly affected by the projected decline in the country’s macroeconomy should the COVID-19 pandemic continue to escalate.

The reduction in domestic economic growth, revenues, and consumption, as well as the slowdown trade relations, will result in an increasing dependency on online processing of trade documents to smoothen the movement of cargo. In addition, bank lending standards will be tighter due to the skewed financial standing of firms and households.

### Industry and Services

In both MSMEs and manufacturing sectors, an increased demand is expected for economic assistance and production of essential goods, such as food, medicine, medical supplies, and other essential goods that would help contain the outbreak, as well as for the reconfiguration of social distancing work protocols. Construction will have to focus on building quarantine and isolation facilities and other health facilities, as well as on rehabilitating existing ones. Service-oriented organizations are seen to implement flexible-work arrangements and virtual interactions.

Repackaging of services and hygiene protocols should be implemented in tourism establishments, as well as eateries that may have to allow for increased preference for take-out menus and online ordering options.

E-commerce will definitely have a big role for retail businesses and consumers since there will be increased reliance on the use of online transactions and financial technology platforms, particularly cashless payment systems.

## Health and Nutrition

Given the continuous threat of COVID-19, focus will be leaning toward ensuring physical and mental health. It will be vital to practice healthy lifestyle and proper hygiene, such as frequent hand washing, bringing hand sanitizers and disinfectants, and physical distancing.

Similarly, it is expected that the health seeking behavior of individuals will be boosted. This could be parallel to the increasing demand for health care services and healthcare providers.

The fear of the disease and its consequences, including separation from the family, death, and loss of jobs, will take its toll on the mental health of individuals, therefore generating an increased demand for and focus on mental health care.

## Social

Wearing of face masks and face shields in public spaces and workplaces will be considered necessary, and physical and social distancing should always be observed to avoid resurgence of cases. Workers will have to get used to working remotely while meetings will be conducted through different kinds of virtual applications.

In education, private and public schools are forced to adopt flexible and blended learnings that include online and offline methods, which involve taking home reading materials and student activities. Teachers will be trained regarding different learning platforms available to avoid physical contact with their students and other people.

The housing sector needs to consider the inclusion of facilities or open areas in the implementation or establishment of quarantine or isolation structures for the affected individuals in the community during the pandemic.

Also, housing design should include disinfecting or sanitation facilities, such as footbath and washing areas, to be used before entry into the main structure to prevent the spread of infectious disease potentially carried by individuals.

## Peace and Security

Maintaining peace and order during the COVID-19 pandemic will be of utmost concern of law enforcement. As part of the strategies to flatten the curve of COVID-19, mass gatherings will continue to be restricted or discouraged and areas that become easily crowded will be strictly monitored.



## Environment

There is an anticipated increase in the volume of infectious waste materials and solid wastes from households and health care facilities. Possible change in the waste characteristics of total solid waste generation is expected; thus, adjustment in solid waste management from collection, treatment, storage, and disposal is critical to prevent contamination and outbreaks.

Similarly, water demand is expected to increase as proper hand washing and regular sanitation of households and public places are given more consideration in the new normal. Ensuring availability of water supply is critical to effectively implement health protocols at the household level.

Although the imposition of ECQ resulted in the decrease of air pollution level, the quality of air is likely to worsen as community quarantine restrictions ease up due to more opportunities for transport.

There would also be increased attention to managing multi-dimensional risks from natural hazard events and public health emergencies.

## Infrastructure and Transportation

### Social Infrastructure Subsector

The transition of health care and on-site construction sectors to the new normal, will require changes in operations and work conditions while observing minimum health standards and safety protocols. Expansion, rehabilitation, and retrofitting of healthcare facilities should be continuously done to ensure that its infrastructure systems are responsive to the needs brought about by another possible pandemic.

To support and address the growing demand, government should prioritize infrastructure projects for non-motorized forms of transport, as improved mobility experiences using such modes can cause more tripmakers to shift.

### Transport Subsector

Access improvements that aid traffic and freight flow will likely be prioritized in an effort to pave the way for safer, multimodal, and more sustainable communities.

Transportation networks must be more connected, accessible, and appealing to diverse users. The emergence of cashless payment schemes and adoption of the latest contactless technologies will be critical to how urban public transport modes operate.

## Energy, Water and Sanitation, and Information and Communications Technology Subsector

With lockdown measures eased and the economy reopened, utility companies and their corresponding infrastructure systems need to build a high degree of flexibility and continued resiliency into their short- and medium-term strategies. They will need to be ready to adjust operations across the process chain and assume that recovery will not be a continuous and linear process.

Greater investments in automation and digitization areas will equip organizations to maintain better business continuity in their supply chains, operations, and customer management, reducing the load on their workforces.

The new normal for operations should thus consider what worked well during the lockdown in terms of virtualization of the work environment and look at the opportunities for future workforce productivity and flexibility, which will rely heavily on information and communications technology (ICT) based systems.

The new normal will require an acceleration in plans for digital infrastructure roll-out. It should be the region's policy to significantly ramp up its communications infrastructure as a focused move toward building a cohesive digital ecosystem to support people, governments, and economies during and beyond the pandemic.

## Peace and Security

Implementation of work-from-home arrangements by LGUs, RLAs, and private sectors will result in the increased reliance on technology and demand for accessible, efficient, and affordable internet services. This will also result in the use of electronic instead of over-the-counter systems for transactions and payment for frontline services by NGAs/RLAs/LGUs. Workplaces will have to be reconfigured due to physical distancing measures. Telecommuting and digital transactions become the viable option.

The implementation of the enhanced Community Based Monitoring System (CBMS) and the Philippine Identification System (PhilSys) by the Philippine Statistics Authority will greatly aid LGUs in facilitating easier identification of recipients and more refined distribution of basic services.

The Sector Plan of the RRP-NCR details the goals, objectives, and strategies necessary to mitigate the losses from the COVID-19 pandemic and to transition to the new normal. Identified strategies were supported by priority programs and projects instrumental to steering the economy to recovery, increasing resilience of communities, and building forward better toward the new normal.

## ECONOMIC SECTOR PLAN

NCR, as one of the most significant contributors to the Gross Domestic Product, has sustained adverse impacts of the COVID-19 pandemic due to the imposition of community quarantine, temporary closures of business establishments, limited consumer spending, restricted travels, and other economic disruptions.

Temporary and permanent closure of establishments entailed foregone revenues for industries, affecting the regional economy of NCR. It has also resulted in displaced workers and more unemployed persons, which could possibly lead to a slowdown in the production of goods and services, suggesting a decrease in labor and output productivity.

### Sector Goal and Objectives

The sector's major goal is to have people's *access to and opportunities for sustainable economic activities and income restored*.

#### Subsector Objectives

- For **Industry**, to redirect production of the manufacturing sector and increase supply of essential goods and intermediate inputs;
- For **MSMEs**, to adhere to business continuity planning and improve capacity-building to strengthen resilience to disruptions;
- For **Retail and E-commerce**, to deliver alternative modes for retail transactions, stable supply of basic necessities, and prime commodities;

- For **IT-BPM**, to continue excellent clientele service worldwide; and
- For **Tourism**, to address and mitigate the immediate and prolonged impacts of the COVID-19 crisis on the tourism industry, with emphasis on a capacitated workforce, sustained businesses, and protected vulnerable groups.

## Strategies

### Industry: Manufacturing

#### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- Adopt and implement guidelines for businesses that will be allowed to operate in coordination with industry groups

#### *Strategies in Defining the New Normal*

- Include critical activities for the supply of essential goods and construction in the Investment Priorities Plan, as well as explore the possible granting of incentives

### Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises

#### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- Provide financial relief to affected companies

#### *Strategies in Defining the New Normal*

- Build MSMEs' resilience through capacity-building on formulating and implementing business continuity plans

### Retail and E-commerce

#### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- Promote and regulate alternative modes to facilitate shopping through personal assistance services or mobilizing “rolling stores”

### ***Strategies in Defining the New Normal***

- Accelerate growth of e-commerce or internet transactions by focusing on speed, security, and structure to increase sales

## **Information Technology and Business Process Management**

### ***Strategies in Mitigating Losses***

- Adopt a last mile connectivity for WFH and/or possible alternative working arrangements in expanded areas of operations.

### ***Strategies in Defining the New Normal***

- Continuous promotion of the Philippines as a destination for IT-BPM services through online promotions or inbound and outbound missions

## **Tourism**

### ***Strategies in Mitigating Losses***

- Reopen and repurpose accommodation establishments as quarantine facilities for returning Overseas Filipinos, composed of OFWs and non-OFWs, in partnership with DOLE and OWWA
- Provide assistance to tourists/travellers affected by the COVID-19 pandemic during community quarantine
- Provide capacity-building for tourism workers on re-skilling and upskilling so that they can maximize their potentials and be able to take on new tasks

### ***Strategies in Defining the New Normal***

- Provide health and safety guidelines in tourism destinations and tourism service centers to adapt to the new normal environment
- Establish institutional measures for the tourism industry in the context of health and safety and digital transformation
- Conduct appropriate marketing and promotion for the new normal environment prioritizing the domestic tourism campaign

# HEALTH SECTOR PLAN

The Philippines does not currently have the capacity to produce and manufacture its own COVID-19 vaccine. The government, however, has sustained close collaboration with several countries and international organizations engaged in the development and manufacture of possible COVID-19 vaccine.

While the global race in developing a vaccine is still ongoing, NCR will continue to abide by the minimum health protocols implemented by the national government, such as hand washing, wearing of face masks, social distancing, and community quarantine, which involves mobility restrictions except for obtaining basic necessities, among others, to contain the spread of the disease.

DOH-NCR at present has multiple programs that are set to be enhanced and/or increased, as reflected in this document. Encapsulated in DOH-NCR's major responsibility as indicated in this Plan is its role in ensuring the nutrition of the populace and in dealing with other health-related issues in general.

To ensure that every plan, program, project, and activity of the sector is aligned with its goal, and to facilitate ease in later monitoring and evaluation, the sector intends to organize into two (2) subsectors, which are health and nutrition. Each sub-sector has enumerated strategies to mitigate the losses from the pandemic, which focus on the medical and non-medical measures to be implemented. These measures were designed to address the COVID-19 situation and to ensure reduction in the financial losses experienced, and consequently preempt a possible domino effect of adverse consequences. Strategies to transition to the new normal were also identified to address the emerging set of challenges and facilitate the transition to the new normal environment.

## Sector Goal and Objectives

The sector's major goal is to have *a responsive health care delivery system fully equipped to ensure continuous access to quality health services and affordable, safe, and nutritious food during emergencies and disasters.*

### *Subsector Objectives*

- For **Health**, to protect human health through timely delivery of health care services in NCR in response to the COVID-19 pandemic
- For **Nutrition**, to increase access to and expedite the delivery of nutrition services to the most vulnerable groups and areas

# Strategies

## Health

### *Strategies to Mitigate Losses*

- Provide timely and relevant health promotion interventions across all settings toward the new normal;
- Strengthen the surveillance system through early case detection and diagnosis and prevent further disease transmission;
- Provide comfortable and safe quarantine facilities to suspect, probable, and confirmed COVID-19 cases (isolation of cases);
- Prevent further complications and mortalities from COVID-19 by providing timely and effective interventions (prompt management);
- Establish a COVID-19 adaptive environment that is safe, resilient, productive, and non-discriminatory (reintegration);
- Protect health care workers and the community from cross transmission within and outside health facilities through effective implementation of logistics management, and safety standards;
- Retrofit service delivery utilizing prescribed DOH work safety guidelines in order to prevent cross transmission in all health facilities; and
- Strengthen and expand the Health Care Providers Network.

### *Strategies to Transition to the New Normal*

- Encourage the public to adopt COVID-19 preventive health behaviors geared towards the new normal;
- Strengthen and expand telehealth system;
- Institutionalize a stronger, locally-managed surveillance system;
- Establish a COVID-19 adaptive environment that is safe, resilient, productive, and non-discriminatory; and
- Establish the resiliency of local government units through the establishment of locally-managed quarantine facilities and bio-molecular laboratories that are fully equipped and operational.

## Nutrition

### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- Conduct policy development, advocacy, and coordination for integrated nutrition response to nutritionally-vulnerable groups;
- Ensure that proper nutrition is provided during emergencies, especially among children, pregnant and breastfeeding women, and senior citizens, who are more vulnerable during emergency situations, consistent with the National Policy on Nutrition Management in Emergencies and Disasters and Nutrition Cluster Advisories;
- Intensify promotion of appropriate Infant and Young Child Feeding (IYCF) practices and good nutrition; and
- Promote adoption of urban agriculture and backyard/ household and community food gardening.

### *Strategies in Defining the New Normal*

- Prevent the deterioration of the nutritional status of vulnerable groups (children under-five-years-old, pregnant and lactating women, and older persons) during the new normal;
- Intensify information, education, and communication (IEC) campaigns on infant and young child feeding, food safety measures, and healthy dietary habits;
- Intensify promotion of urban agriculture and backyard/ household and community food gardening for improved household food security; Build capacities of local government units in nutrition information management and nutrition program management; and
- Assess and monitor nutrition situations through prescribed monitoring tools.



# SOCIAL SECTOR PLAN

The social sector has been greatly affected by the COVID-19 outbreak, particularly with regard to protecting poor and high-risk individuals. During these challenging times, strengthening the capacity of social protection systems remains an urgent task for the country to ensure the well-being of vulnerable persons.

The enforcement of community quarantine in Metro Manila compelled industries and service sectors to reconfigure their operating schedules and practices, which resulted in a considerable number of displaced workers.

Another area heavily affected by the pandemic is the education sector. The Department of Education delayed the opening of classes to ensure the health and safety of learners, teachers, and personnel during the time of pandemic. To address the challenges in basic education and to continue to confront the effects brought about by the unforeseen public health issues, the major response of DepEd is to implement the Learning Continuity Plan (LCP) effective school year 2020-2021.

With regard to the housing structure, the recommended social distancing and self-isolation measures proved difficult to follow due to families residing in crowded areas, particularly the poor and informal settlers. There is a need for everyone to have a safe and resilient house to be able to implement containment and mitigation measures in adapting to the new normal.

To address the issues and concerns brought about by COVID-19 and to adapt to the new normal, the social sector was divided into four (4) subsectors, namely: a) social protection, b) labor and employment, c) education, and d) housing. This is done to effectively achieve the desired outcome of the sector's goal, objectives, and strategies and to make sure that resources will be used effectively in the identified proposed programs and projects.

## Sector Goal and Objectives

The sector's major goal is to have people's *access to social protection, employment, housing, and education programs improved.*

### *Subsector Objectives*

- For **Social Protection**, to increase access to and expedite the delivery of social services

- For **Labor and Employment**, to provide better access to social welfare programs, wage subsidies, and retooling training for displaced workers
- For **Education**, to adopt flexible and blended learning
- For **Housing**, to integrate public health goals

## Strategies

### Social Protection

#### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- Strengthen social services initiatives to ensure that the people are protected from the pandemic and have access to necessities, such as food and medicine

#### *Strategies in Defining the New Normal*

- Develop a registry of vulnerable persons and groups
- Explore the possibility of automatic and universal release of aid
- Promote savings mobilization
- Revisit and strictly implement rules and regulations as well as ordinances of local government units related to pandemic

### Labor and Employment

#### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- Continue wage subsidies, cash-for-work, and training programs to provide temporary employment and income to severely affected workers

#### *Strategies in Defining the New Normal*

- Improve social protection programs and income support systems
- Retool the labor force
- Issue standard guidelines on alternative work arrangement for both private and public sectors

## Education

### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- School calendar adjustment for SY 2019-2020 and SY 2020-2021

### *Strategies in Defining the New Normal*

- Encourage stakeholders to support schools and the wider community in helping young people to stay connected with their learning through different platforms and schemes
- Promote and expedite the formulation of a multi-modal, multi-strategy Learning Continuity Plan (LCP)
- Prioritize investment in online platforms including the development, validation, and reproduction of self-learning modules

## Education

### *Strategies in Mitigating Losses*

- Install temporary disinfecting/sanitation areas before entry into the main structure (e.g., foot bath, washing areas)

### *Strategies in Defining the New Normal*

- Incorporate hazard and health standards in the updated Comprehensive Land Use Plans (CLUPs) and zoning ordinances
- Explore the inclusion of an open or public space
- Prioritize the implementation of the Housing Rental Subsidy Program for low-income informal settler families (ISFs)

# PEACE AND SECURITY SECTOR PLAN

While the negative effects of COVID-19 took its toll on the health of Metro Manila residents, restricting travel and imposing community lockdown, among others, have become necessary measures to contain the spread of the virus. These measures imposed by the national government to control COVID-19 transmission have yielded positive results with regard to decreasing the incidence of crime in NCR.

Based on the comparative statistics provided by PNP-NCRPO, the incidence of eight (8) focus crimes (i.e., murder, homicide, physical injury, rape, robbery, theft, and carnapping) dropped by 60.06 percent for the period covering March 15-July 10, 2020 (1,590 crimes) compared with crime incidence during the same period last year (3,981 crimes).

As part of the measures to implement quarantine guidelines and protocols, law enforcers conducted 643 operations against illegal gambling during the quarantine period from March 15-July 10, 2020 in different areas in Metro Manila. In addition, a total of 63,258 curfew violators were apprehended during the same period. Lastly, a total of 25,350 policemen were deployed in strategic locations in the region to maintain peace and order.

With regard to the peace and security sector plan, the sector goals, objectives, and strategies are discussed below as support to the sector's identified investment programs.

## Sector Goal and Objectives

The sector's major goal is to have an *orderly, safe, and peaceful environment ensured during emergencies*.

### Sector Objectives

- Ensure and maintain public safety and peace and order in Metro Manila during emergencies
- Provide security assistance in the delivery of public services; and
- Ensure protection and safety of vulnerable sectors from domestic violence and other related cases.

## Strategies

### Ensure cybersecurity and maximize use of technology

- There is a need to intensify public awareness on cybercrime due to a major shift from using conventional transactions to modern or online transactions and media posting in this time of pandemic
- Strengthen cybersecurity for online transactions through regulations and collaboration with government security agencies to protect all stakeholders
- Improve community-based surveillance for easier monitoring of activities of people in the community

### Ensure strict and effective implementation of quarantine guidelines

- Ensure representation in the creation of the Local Inter-Agency Peace and Security Council for smooth implementation of quarantine protocols on the ground and continuous coordination and active participation in the same

### Strengthen coordination among government security agencies and the public

- Ensure multi-sectoral coordination among various stakeholders for peace and order and public safety

### Increase police visibility in strategic locations

- Increasing the police visibility on the ground will deter and reduce crime; thus, increased investment in these activities during this pandemic is significant

### Ensure safety and health of PDLs in jail facilities

- Implement precautionary measures in jail facilities by providing necessary PPEs and health kits in order to protect PDLs and personnel from COVID-19

# ENVIRONMENT SECTOR PLAN

The overall goal of the environmental sector plan is to contribute in reducing the pressure on regional health capacity by improving environmental quality and public health to avoid the risk of emergence of seasonal and new disease outbreaks.

Air pollution levels in NCR decreased by around 40 percent to 66 percent during the first weeks of the ECQ. However, as community quarantine restrictions ease up, air pollution level is evidently rebounding. This will be crucial as a growing consensus in the scientific community points to the important role improving air quality could play in overcoming the pandemic. Temporary reduction in daily carbon emissions due to restrictions in transportation and industrial activities was noted. However, this is expected to rebound when the energy demand for transportation and industries change as social distancing is implemented in the new normal. Electricity consumption from households will also contribute to the increase in carbon emissions.

Amid the COVID-19 pandemic, the volume of solid waste generated, particularly medical and other hazardous wastes from health care facilities and households, is expected to increase.

## Sector Goal and Objectives

The sector's main goal is to have a *safe, clean, and healthy environment for urban communities ensured to prevent future disease outbreaks.*

### Sector Objectives

- To streamline the management of health care and infectious wastes
- To maintain integrity of remaining conservation areas
- To ensure water and air quality improvement
- To promote ancillary actions to advance public health and mitigate climate change

## Strategies

### Streamlining the management of health care and infectious waste

- Ensure compliance of healthcare facilities and treatment technologies with the standards for hazardous waste management

- Modernize and increase the number of treatment, storage, and disposal (TSD) facilities
- Improve disposal of health care wastes at the household or barangay level

## Maintaining the integrity of remaining conservation areas

- Intensify surveillance and enforcement activities
- Prioritize undertaking research and development (R&D) on the utilization of natural resources for disease prevention and cure

## Ensuring Air and Water Quality Improvement

### *Air Quality*

- Ensure compliance of establishments, industries, and motor vehicles to air quality standards
- Modernize air quality monitoring systems

### *Water Quality*

- Strengthen the regulation of point sources and nonpoint sources of water pollution
- Modernize water quality monitoring systems

## Promoting ancillary actions to advance public health and mitigate climate change

- Permanent adoption of telecommuting work arrangement for both private and public sectors
- Enhance open and green urban spaces
- More jobs in the waste management sector
- Mass media campaign to promote environmental and public health awareness and positive behavioral change

# INFRASTRUCTURE AND TRANSPORTATION SECTOR PLAN

According to the National Capital Region Regional Development Plan (NCR-RDP) 2017-2022, the infrastructure sector is one of the major driving forces that support the socioeconomic activities of the country toward development. This was made more apparent by the infrastructure development sector being considered as one of the topmost priority of the government in the region over the past years, with substantial allocations from the national budget.

The focus on the infrastructure and transportation sector stems from its nature as an output multiplier, which greatly stimulates the country's economic activity through job generation and materials importation and exportation, to name a few, and its support to all the capacities of the different development sectors.

In an attempt to lower the cases of COVID-19 in the country, restrictions on land, air, and sea travel were put in place. The operation of public mass transportation modes such as trains and buses were halted or limited. Intercity, inter-regional, and international transportation were heavily restricted or suspended.

This resulted in the interruption of the supply and demand chain in the delivery of goods and services. Infrastructure construction projects were stopped or limited, given the scarcity of manpower and materials, which subsequently caused delays in the implementation and completion of projects. Operations for both public and private sectors were not optimal, given the adoption of alternative work arrangements such as the work-from-home and skeleton workforce schemes.

In response to the issues stated above, operational safety and health protocols were enforced when using public transportation and during the resumption of infrastructure construction. There was also an increase in the demand for non-motorized modes of transportation, such as walking and cycling.

In terms of energy and other utilities, there was a notable shift in the sectoral energy consumption pattern. The bulk of demand shifted from industrial and commercial use to residential use, thus affecting the supply norm in the region. Service-related activities, which include the repair and maintenance of utility lines and customer meter reading, were conducted with difficulty or delay, which affected the service quality of utility providers. Utility bills payment was also deferred, affecting the financial resources flow from both the service provider side and the consumers.



## Sector Goal and Objectives

The sector's primary goal is to have *continued, reliable, and seamless delivery of services ensured through safe and responsive infrastructure during disease outbreaks or similar events.*

### Subsector Objectives

- For **Social Infrastructure**, to ensure the construction of safe and responsive infrastructure
- For **Transportation**, to ensure seamless and safe transport of people and goods
- For **Energy**, to ensure the steady and uninterrupted supply of fuel and power
- For **Water and Sanitation**, to ensure water security and sanitation
- For **Information and Communication Technology**, to ensure reliable internet service and seamless ICT systems

## Strategies

### Social Infrastructure

- Adopt digital technologies in the construction sector, particularly modular designs and structural specifications that can be replicated across the country
- Provide incentives to construction companies that will prioritize building isolation or temporary hospitals for suspected and probable cases of COVID-19
- Strictly enforce existing policies on the processing of permits
- Improve public infrastructures

### Transportation

- Fast track and ensure continued implementation of transport projects
- Meet mobility requirements of the commuting public and ensure unhampered movement of goods and services to support economic activities

- Control the spread of the virus through the reduction of transmission through the implementation of stringent health and sanitary protocols and reduction of contact in transportation services
- Leverage digital technologies to provide better transportation services

## Energy

- Allow unimpeded movement of energy personnel, goods, and services
- Promote greater utilization of indigenous and renewable energy resources
- Adopt the use of more energy efficient appliances and equipment
- Leverage the use of smart technologies along the energy supply chain
- Implement energy projects halted during the community quarantine
- Promote investment for additional capacities and energy facilities

## Water and Sanitation

- Enhance water conservation and efficiency measures to avert water shortages
- Expand existing and develop new and sustainable water sources to meet the expected increase in water demand and to improve access to safe and adequate water ensuring water security and reliability
- Expand and develop wastewater treatment facilities with support from local and national agencies to expedite the rehabilitation and restoration of the coastal and marine ecosystem of main water bodies and their adjacent water tributaries

## Information and Communications Technology

- Establish digital taxation framework
- Fast-track the implementation of programs for ICT-enabled government to ensure greater public reach and safer, protected, faster, and reliable ICT
- Stronger collaboration with the private sector for ICT programs to fast track implementation

# GOVERNANCE SECTOR PLAN

As frontliners in delivering public service to its constituents, local government units are expected to play an important role in responding to the COVID-19 pandemic, in close coordination with national government agencies. LGUs are also responsible for rolling out nationally-funded programs on health and social safety nets, implementation of community quarantine measures, and continuous provision of goods and basic services to its constituents.

The IATF adopted this strategy weeks after President Duterte signed the *Bayanihan to Heal as One Act*, which grants him 30 special powers to address the COVID-19 pandemic, followed by the rollout of the IATF's National Action Plan to contain the virus.

As frontliners in delivering public service to its constituents, local government units are expected to play an important role in responding to the COVID-19 pandemic, in close coordination with national government agencies. LGUs are also responsible for rolling out nationally-funded programs on health and social safety nets, implementation of community quarantine measures, and continuous provision of goods and basic services to its constituents.

Nevertheless, even before the IATF announcements, Metro Manila LGUs have already conducted their own initiatives to extend help to their constituents in whatever way they can. During this time of the pandemic, the LGUs try their best to provide or meet the needs of their constituents. The LGUs have even released a number of resolutions to support the implementation of ordinances and the release of funds for the purchase, production, and delivery of essential goods, resources, and services during the pandemic.

Some of the identified challenges faced by the local government in responding to public health emergencies, such as pandemics, are as follows: (1) the need for an updated database of their constituents, which is critical in the identification of targeted beneficiaries of SAP; (2) inconsistency of local policies with national policies in terms of the implementation of community quarantine guidelines or protocols; and (3) level of capability of LGUs in responding to emergency crises.

## Sector Goal and Objectives

The sector's major goal is to have the **capacity of Metro Manila LGUs and regional line agencies to effectively respond, plan, and collaborate with stakeholders to address public health emergencies ensured.**

## *Sector Objectives*

- Increase resilience and technical capabilities of LGUs and NGAs to perform their functions during health emergencies
- Enhance coordination and cooperation among stakeholders, such as NGAs, the private sector, and civil society
- Maximize the use of technology to ensure and improve the delivery of public services
- Improve linkages and pool resources of the government, the private sector, and communities to better respond to health emergencies

## **Strategies**

- Empower and enhance capacities of LGUs, starting at the barangay level, as first responders and frontline service delivery units
- Strengthen coordination and cooperation between and among the national government, LGUs, the private sector, and CSOs to enable whole-of-society response
- Fast-track the implementation of programs for ICT-enabled government to facilitate service delivery and ensure public reach in the context of the new normal
- Promote and build capacity of LGUs and RLAs on rehabilitation and recovery planning to ensure the continuity of essential government services in times of health emergencies and disasters

## Program Implementation Mechanism

The implementation of the RRP-NCR requires close coordination between and among national and regional line agencies and local government units, as well as the private sector and civil society organizations.

The RRP-NCR will be presented to the NCR RTF COVID-19 for support and endorsement of the member agencies.

Likewise, the RRP-NCR will be presented to the Regional Development Council of NCR for support and endorsement of the 17 Metro Manila LGUs. Upon the approval of the Council, the same will be submitted to the NDRRMC, RLAs, and Metro Manila LGUs for funding/augmentation.

The NDRRMC shall then determine programs and projects eligible for NDRRM Fund, while others can be funded by the central offices of their concerned agencies.

Each regional line agency and LGUs, with support from the private sector and other development partners, will implement programs, activities and projects in accordance with the strategies as enumerated in each of the sectoral plans.

The RRP-NCR will also be used in updating the targets and strategies of the Regional Development Plan of the NCR (RDP-NCR) 2017-2022, which will aim for a healthy and resilient Metro Manila. Identified strategies both for mitigating losses and transitioning to the new normal will be incorporated in the chapters of the RDP-NCR 2017-2020 during the midterm updating. Priority programs and projects will also be integrated in the formulation of the Regional Development Investment Program of the NCR (RDIP-NCR).

The report will be used by various agencies in government in reconsideration of their priorities for the rest for of 2020 and for the full year from 2021 to 2022.

The adoption of the RRP-NCR at the local level will be realized when the identified strategies and priority programs and projects are integrated in the formulation of

their respective local RRP. Said activity will be under the direct supervision of OCD-NCR, in collaboration with all local DRRM offices in the region.

## Monitoring and Implementation

During the implementation period of the priority programs and projects (2020 to 2022), the effectiveness and efficiency of the identified strategies in realizing the chapter objectives will be monitored and evaluated for every sector of the Plan.

To ensure synchronization of the programs and projects and implementation of the responsibilities of the RLAs and LGUs, the NCR RTF Economic Sector Secretariat shall lead its implementation, coordination, and monitoring and evaluation.

Various agencies actively involved in the formulation of the RRP-NCR also have vital roles to play in monitoring their work progress to realize the RRP-NCR objectives. Regular reporting to the RTF NCR Economic Cluster of the implementation progress shall be required through the submission of accomplishment reports.



# **ANNEXES**

**ANNEX 1: RTF-NCR COVID-19 RESOLUTION NO. 22**  
*SUPPORTING AND APPROVING THE REHABILITATION AND  
RECOVERY PLAN FOR THE NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION (RRP-NCR)*

**ANNEX 2: OVERALL SECRETARIAT**

Republic of the Philippines



**REGIONAL TASK FORCE COVID-19**  
**NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION**

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**RTF-NCR COVID-19**  
**RESOLUTION NO. 22**  
Series of 2020

**SUPPORTING AND APPROVING THE REHABILITATION AND RECOVERY PLAN FOR THE  
NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION (RRP-NCR)**

**WHEREAS**, pursuant to IATF Resolution No. 16 s. 2020, the National Action Plan for COVID-19 and the Organizational Structure for the National Task Force (NTF) and Regional Task Force (RTF), and Local Task Force (LTF) for COVID-19 was approved;

**WHEREAS**, pursuant to IATF-EID Resolution No. 23 series 2020 *“Recommendations Relative to the Management of the Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19) Situation”*, the Metropolitan Manila Development Authority (MMDA) was designated as the Chairperson of the Regional Task Force of the National Capital Region (RTF-NCR).

**WHEREAS**, the MMDA being the Chair of the RTF NCR COVID-19 and Economy Cluster Lead was tasked to lead the formulation of Rehabilitation and Recovery Plan for the National Capital Region (RRP-NCR).

**WHEREAS**, the RTF NCR COVID-19 Economic Cluster Secretariat conducted a series of consultations, bilateral meetings to solicit inputs from regional line agencies, Metro Manila local government units (LGUs), private sectors and non-government organizations for the preparation of RRP-NCR;

**WHEREAS**, a validation workshop was conducted on 16 July 2020 wherein the latest RRP-NCR draft was presented and validated by the stakeholders;

**WHEREAS**, the RRP-NCR aims to characterize the responses amid the COVID-19 crisis, identify the rehabilitation and recovery strategies to adapt to the “new normal” through integrating the *“We Recover As One”* report published by the IATF – Technical Working Group for Anticipatory and Forward Planning (TWG-AFP) and the rehabilitation and recovery efforts of various stakeholders and partners, and then present the list of programs and projects needed to carry out the identified strategies set out in this plan.

**WHEREAS**, the RRP-NCR is anchored to the strategies on rebuilding confidence and adjust to the impacts of the COVID-19 pandemic and the “new normal” pursuant to *“We Recover As One”*, and consistently realigned to the adopted National Disaster Risk Reduction Management (DRRM) Framework overall long-term goal of a *“safer, adaptive, and disaster resilient Filipino communities that are protected from risks and can cope with and recover quickly from emerging and infectious disease outbreaks”* in accordance with the *Rehabilitation and Recovery Planning Guide 2019*;

**WHEREAS**, the Regional Line Agencies, Metro Manila LGUs, private sectors and non-government organizations issued their concurrence to the latest draft of the RRP-NCR, consistent to their respective mandates, thrust and priorities, and now presents the same for the RTF’s approval;

**WHEREAS**, the RRP-NCR provides strategic interventions for the National Capital Region to mitigate the losses from the COVID-19 pandemic and the imposition of Enhanced Community Quarantine (ECQ) and to adapt to the “new normal”. It contains the assessment of effects of pandemic, accompanied by an investment program – a list of key programs, projects, and



activities (PAPs) needed to steer the economy to recovery and increase resilience of communities.

**NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED**, as it is hereby resolved, that the RTF-NCR COVID-19 hereby **SUPPORTS** and **APPROVES** the Rehabilitation and Recovery Plan for the National Capital Region.

**APPROVED** by the RTF-NCR COVID-19 this 25th day of September 2020.

  
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MMDA

  
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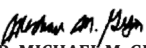
  
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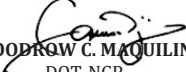
  
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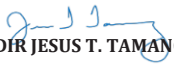
  
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*Assistant General Manager for Planning*

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## **REHABILITATION AND RECOVERY PLAN FOR THE NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION Abridged Version**

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